Printed by: filippo.fiz@uptoten.it. Printing is for personal, private use only. No part of this book may be reproduced or transmitted without publisher's prior permission. Violators will be prosecuted.

Marketing executive for Magu Corporation: Whenever Magu opens a manufacturing facility in a new city, the company should sponsor, or make donations to, a number of nonprofit organizations in that city. Doing so would improve Magu's image in the community, and thus the money spent on such charitable ventures would lead to increased sales.

Which statement would, if true, point to the most serious weakness in the marketing executive's advice?

A. Magu sells its products internationally, so sales in any one city represent only a small portion of total revenue.

B. Spending on charitable ventures would require Magu to decrease direct advertisements, which are the most effective means of reaching its target customers.

C. If market conditions change, Magu may have to close any such facility or relocate it.

D. Some nonprofit organizations are poorly organized, so money donated to them would be of little benefit to the community.

E. If workers at the manufacturing facility believed their wages or working conditions were poor, their complaints would outweigh any good impressions generated by Magu's donations or sponsorships.

Evaluation of a Plan

Situation A marketing executive for Magu Corporation argues that Magu can increase its sales if it sponsors or donates to nonprofit organizations in any city in which it opens a new manufacturing facility, because doing so would improve its image in that city and increase sales.

Reasoning *What would most strongly suggest that Magu would not increase sales even if it followed the plan proposed by the marketing executive?* Sponsoring or donating to nonprofit organizations would require the use of financial assets that therefore cannot be spent elsewhere. If as a result Magu had to cut other expenditures that drive sales more effectively than funding nonprofit organizations drives sales, the plan may not succeed.

A. Because Magu sells its products internationally and no one city represents more than a small portion of revenue, any increase in sales in any given city will have only a slight effect on total sales; nonetheless, sales could still rise.

B. **Correct.** If sponsoring or donating to a nonprofit would require Magu to reduce advertising, and advertising is the most effective means of reaching its target customers, then any positive influence on sales resulting from the charitable venture might be overwhelmed by a decrease in sales because of the advertising cuts.

C. The fact that Magu might have to close or relocate one of these new facilities does not suggest that the marketing executive's plan would not work; Magu's image could nonetheless improve and sales could increase as a result.

D. Even if some nonprofit organizations are poorly organized, others may not be, and Magu could limit its support to those.

E. Even if such complaints from workers would outweigh any benefit arising from Magu's support of nonprofit organizations, this does not indicate that the marketing executive's plan will not work, because we have no reason to think that the workers will in fact be dissatisfied with their wages or working conditions.

The correct answer is B.

•

In the last few years, plant scientists have been able to genetically engineer seeds to produce crops highly resistant to insect damage. Farmers growing crops with these seeds will be able to spend significantly less on pesticides. This cost reduction would more than make up for the higher cost of the genetically engineered seeds. Clearly, therefore, farmers who grow crops from genetically engineered seeds will be able to reduce their costs by using them.

Which of the following, if true, most weakens the argument?

A. Plant scientists have not yet developed insect-resistant strains of every crop that is currently grown commercially.

B. The cost of several commonly used pesticides is expected to rise in the next few years.

DO NOT COPY filippo.fiz@uptoten.it

Printed by: filippo.fiz@uptoten.it. Printing is for personal, private use only. No part of this book may be reproduced or transmitted without publisher's prior permission. Violators will be prosecuted.

B. The cost of several commonly used pesticides is expected to rise in the next few years.

C. Crops grown from the genetically engineered seeds require significantly more fertilizer and water to grow well than do crops grown from nonengineered seeds.

D. In the future, the cost of genetically engineered seeds is likely to fall to the level of nonengineered seeds.

E. The crops that now require the greatest expenditure on pesticides are not the ones for which genetically engineered seeds will become available.

Argument Evaluation

Situation Farmers who grow crops with seeds that have been genetically engineered to produce crops resistant to insect damage will be able to spend less on pesticides. Though these seeds are more expensive than regular seeds, this greater cost will be more than compensated for by lower expenditures on pesticides.

Reasoning *What claim most weakens the argument's support for the claim that farmers who grow crops from these genetically engineered seeds will be able to reduce their costs by using them?* The argument gives us good reason to think that even though these seeds are more expensive, the added expense is less than the amount that farmers will save by reducing their pesticide usage. But the argument does not tell us how the use of these seeds affects other costs the farmer might have. If, for instance, crops grown from these seeds require greater use of fertilizer or water, costs may stay stable or even increase.

A. The argument's conclusion is only that farmers who grow crops using these seeds will be able to reduce their costs. The argument does not claim that every farmer will be able to reduce costs for every crop the farmer produces.

B. If the cost of pesticides will increase in the next few years, this gives us some reason to believe that farmers who use these genetically engineered seeds to grow crops will have lower costs than they would have if they used other seeds to grow the same crops. That strengthens rather than weakens the argument's support for its conclusion.

C. **Correct.** As discussed above, if crops grown with the genetically engineered seeds require the use of more fertilizer or water, the farmer who uses such seeds may not see a reduction in costs.

D. If the genetically engineered seeds eventually become no more expensive than regular seeds, then it is more likely that farmers growing crops with these genetically engineered seeds will see their costs reduced.

E. This answer choice indicates that farmers will not be able to reduce costs as much as they might if all crops could be grown using seeds that are genetically engineered to produce crops resistant to insect damage. That, however, is fully consistent with the possibility that if farmers grow crops using the genetically engineered seeds that are available, they will thereby be able to reduce their costs.

The correct answer is C.

•

Educational theorist: Recent editorials have called for limits on the amount of homework assigned to schoolchildren younger than 12. They point out that free-time activities play an important role in childhood development and that homework in large quantities can severely restrict children's free time, hindering their development. But the actual average homework time for children under 12—little more than 30 minutes per night—leaves plenty of free time. In reality, therefore, the editorials' rationale cannot justify the restriction they advocate.

Which of the following, if true, would most seriously call into question the educational theorist's conclusion?

A. Some teachers give as homework assignments work of a kind that research suggests is most effective educationally when done in class.

B. For children younger than 12, regularly doing homework in the first years of school has no proven academic value, but many educators believe that it fosters self-discipline and time management.

C. Some homework assignments are related to free-time activities that children engage in, such as reading or hobbies.

D. A substantial proportion of schoolchildren under 12, particularly those in their first few years of school, have less than 10 minutes of homework assigned per night.

DO NOT COPY filippo.fiz@uptoten.it

Printed by: filippo.fiz@uptoten.it. Printing is for personal, private use only. No part of this book may be reproduced or transmitted without publisher's prior permission. Violators will be prosecuted.

less than 10 minutes of homework assigned per night.

E. Some free-time activities teach children skills or information that they later find useful in their schoolwork.

Argument Evaluation

Situation An educational theorist points out that recent editorials have called for limits on the amount of homework assigned to children under the age of 12, since large amounts of homework can restrict the sort of free-time activities that are crucial to their development. The theorist argues that such restrictions are not justified, because children under 12 spend on average only 30 minutes on homework. That leaves plenty of time for other activities.

Reasoning *What would most seriously call the theorist's conclusion into question?* The theorist gives only the average amount of time children under the age of 12 spend on homework. However, the editorials advocated a limit on the maximum amount of homework assigned, not on the average amount across all schoolchildren. There could be a wide variation among the amounts of time different children spend on homework. While a large number of children may spend only a short amount of time on homework, some children may spend much longer. For those who have the greater amounts of homework, this might leave little time for important free-time activities.

A. This claim, if true, may suggest that certain types of homework that teachers assign would be better done in class. It might be best not to give such assignments for homework, but that does not give us much reason to think that the *amount* of homework should be restricted.

B. This choice indicates that, despite a possible objection to assigning homework, homework does have value. That does not tell us, though, whether the maximum amount of homework that is assigned is too much, too little, or just right.

C. This claim could be true and yet children could still be left with too little time for important free-time activities.

D. **Correct.** As explained in the Reasoning section above, the educational theorist draws a conclusion regarding whether there should be a limit on the *maximum* amount of homework assigned to children under 12 and bases this conclusion solely on the *average* amount of time children under the age of 12 spend on homework. This conclusion would not be well supported if there is a wide variation in the amount of time children under the age of 12 spend on homework and if some—perhaps in the lower grades—spend only a very short amount of time on it. Suppose, for instance, as this answer choice has, that less than 10 minutes of homework is assigned to some of these children each night. If that were the case, then because the average amount of time schoolchildren under the age of 12 spend on homework each night is 30 minutes, that would mean that many schoolchildren may be spending far more than 30 minutes a night on homework. If so, then those children may not have enough free time for other important activities. That might mean that it would be appropriate to put limits on the amount of homework assigned to children under the age of 12.

E. This claim shows that some free-time activities are important for schoolwork later in life. But that does not tell us whether the maximum amount of homework that is assigned is too much, too little, or just right.

The correct answer is D.

•

Thyrian lawmaker: Thyria's Cheese Importation Board inspects all cheese shipments to Thyria and rejects shipments not meeting specified standards. Yet only 1 percent is ever rejected. Therefore, since the health consequences and associated economic costs of not rejecting that 1 percent are negligible, whereas the board's operating costs are considerable, for economic reasons alone the board should be disbanded.

Consultant: I disagree. The threat of having their shipments rejected deters many cheese exporters from shipping substandard product.

The consultant responds to the lawmaker's argument by

A. rejecting the lawmaker's argument while proposing that the standards according to which the board inspects imported cheese should be raised

B. providing evidence that the lawmaker's argument has significantly overestimated the cost of maintaining the board

C. objecting to the lawmaker's introducing into the discussion factors that are not strictly economic

DO NOT COPY filippo.fiz@uptoten.it

Printed by: filippo.fiz@uptoten.it. Printing is for personal, private use only. No part of this book may be reproduced or transmitted without publisher's prior permission. Violators will be prosecuted.

D. pointing out a benefit of maintaining the board which the lawmaker's argument has failed to consider

E. shifting the discussion from the argument at hand to an attack on the integrity of the cheese inspectors

Argument Construction

Situation The Thyrian lawmaker argues that the Cheese Importation Board should be disbanded, because its operating costs are high and it rejects only a small percentage of the cheese it inspects. The consultant disagrees, pointing out that the board's inspections deter those who export cheese to Thyria from shipping substandard cheese.

Reasoning *What strategy does the consultant use in the counterargument?* The consultant indicates to the lawmaker that there is a reason to retain the board that the lawmaker has not considered. The benefit the board provides is not that it identifies a great deal of substandard cheese and rejects it (thus keeping the public healthy), but that the possibility that their cheese could be found substandard is what keeps exporters from attempting to export low-quality cheese to Thyria.

A. The consultant does reject the lawmaker's argument, but the consultant does not propose higher standards. Indeed, in suggesting that the board should be retained, the consultant implies that the board's standards are appropriate.

B. The consultant does not provide any evidence related to the board's cost.

C. The only point the lawmaker raises that is not strictly economic is about the health consequences of disbanding the board, but the consultant does not address this point at all.

D. **Correct.** This statement properly identifies the strategy the consultant employs in his or her counterargument. The consultant points out that the board provides a significant benefit that the lawmaker did not consider.

E. The consultant does not attack the integrity of the cheese inspectors; to the contrary, the consultant says that their inspections deter the cheese exporters from shipping substandard cheese.

The correct answer is D.

•

The tulu, a popular ornamental plant, does not reproduce naturally and is only bred and sold by specialized horticultural companies. Unfortunately, the tulu is easily devastated by a contagious fungal rot. The government ministry plans to reassure worried gardeners by requiring all tulu plants to be tested for fungal rot before being sold. However, infected plants less than 30 weeks old have generally not built up enough fungal rot in their systems to be detected reliably. And many tulu plants are sold before they are 24 weeks old.

Which of the following, if performed by the government ministry, could logically be expected to overcome the problem with their plan to test for the fungal rot?

A. Releasing a general announcement that tulu plants less than 30 weeks old cannot be effectively tested for fungal rot

B. Requiring all tulu plants less than 30 weeks old to be labeled as such

C. Researching possible ways to test tulu plants less than 24 weeks old for fungal rot

D. Ensuring that tulu plants are not sold before they are 30 weeks old

E. Quarantining all tulu plants from horticultural companies at which any case of fungal rot has been detected until those tulu plants can be tested for fungal rot

Evaluation of a Plan

Situation There is a contagious fungal rot that devastates the tulu, a popular ornamental plant. To reassure worried gardeners, the government ministry plans to require that tulu plants be tested for the rot before being sold. However, many tulu plants are sold before they are 24 weeks old, yet fungal rot in plants less than 30 weeks old generally cannot be detected reliably.

Reasoning *What could the government ministry do to overcome the problem?* The problem arises from the fact that tulu plants are frequently sold before they are 24 weeks old, which is too soon for any fungal rot that is present to have built up enough in their root systems to be detected. Since the goal of the

DO NOT COPY filippo.fiz@uptoten.it

Printed by: filippo.fiz@uptoten.it. Printing is for personal, private use only. No part of this book may be reproduced or transmitted without publisher's prior permission. Violators will be prosecuted.

that is present to have built up enough in their root systems to be detected. Since the goal of the testing is to ensure that infected tulu plants are not sold, an obvious solution would be to make sure that no plants are sold before they are old enough for fungal rot to have built up to a detectable level. Thus, tulu plants should not be sold before they are 30 weeks old.

A. Releasing such an announcement would help overcome the problem if it guaranteed that no one would buy or sell tulu plants before the plants were 30 weeks old, but it is far from certain that it would guarantee this.

B. Similar to A, introducing such labeling would help overcome the problem if it guaranteed that no one would buy or sell tulu plants before the plants were 30 weeks old, but it is far from certain that it would guarantee this.

C. There is no guarantee that such research will be successful at reducing the age at which tulu plants can be reliably tested.

D. **Correct.** If the government *ensures* that no tulu plants less than 30 weeks of age are sold, then the specific problem mentioned in the passage would be overcome.

E. This will not help overcome the problem. Such a quarantine program might lead horticultural companies to start selling tulu plants *only* if they are less than 24 weeks old, thereby minimizing the chance of quarantine by minimizing the chance of detection.

The correct answer is D.

•

While many people think of genetic manipulation of food crops as being aimed at developing larger and larger plant varieties, some plant breeders have in fact concentrated on discovering or producing dwarf varieties, which are roughly half as tall as normal varieties.

Which of the following would, if true, most help to explain the strategy of the plant breeders referred to above?

A. Plant varieties used as food by some are used as ornamentals by others.

B. The wholesale prices of a given crop decrease as the supply of it increases.

C. Crops once produced exclusively for human consumption are often now used for animal feed.

D. Short plants are less vulnerable to strong wind and heavy rains.

E. Nations with large industrial sectors tend to consume more processed grains.

Evaluation of a Plan

Situation Some plant breeders have concentrated on discovering or producing certain species of food crop plants to be roughly half as tall as normal varieties.

Reasoning *Why would some plant breeders concentrate on discovering or producing smaller varieties of certain food crops?* Presumably, these breeders would not seek smaller varieties of plant crops unless the smaller size conveyed some benefit. If short plants were less vulnerable to strong wind and heavy rains, they would be apt to be more productive, other things being equal. Plant breeders would have reason to try to discover or produce such more productive varieties.

A. This statement doesn't indicate whether those who use the plants as ornamentals desire shorter varieties.

B. At most this suggests that higher productivity is not as much of an advantage as it otherwise would be. But there is nothing in the passage that indicates that smaller varieties would be more productive than normal-sized plants.

C. No reason is given for thinking that smaller varieties of plants are more conducive to use for animal feed than are larger varieties.

D. **Correct.** This answer choice is correct because—unlike the other choices—it helps explain why smaller plant varieties could sometimes be preferable to larger varieties. A plant that is less vulnerable to wind and rain is apt to suffer less damage. This is a clear advantage that would motivate plant breeders to try to discover or produce smaller varieties.

E. This has no direct bearing on the question posed. Processed grains are not even mentioned in the passage, let alone linked to smaller plant varieties.

The correct answer is D.

DO NOT COPY filippo.fiz@uptoten.it

Printed by: filippo.fiz@uptoten.it. Printing is for personal, private use only. No part of this book may be reproduced or transmitted without publisher's prior permission. Violators will be prosecuted.

The correct answer is D.

•

Secret passwords are often used to control access to computers. When employees select their own passwords, they frequently choose such easily guessed passwords as their initials or birth dates. To improve security, employers should assign randomly generated passwords to employees rather than allowing employees to make up their own.

Which of the following, if true, most seriously undermines the conclusion drawn above?

A. If passwords are generated randomly, it is theoretically possible that employees will be assigned passwords that they might have selected on their own.

B. Randomly generated passwords are so difficult for employees to recall that they often record the passwords in places where the passwords could be easily seen by others.

C. Computer systems protected by passwords are designed to ignore commands that are entered by employees or others who use invalid passwords.

D. In general, the higher the level of security maintained at the computer system, the more difficult it is for unauthorized users to obtain access to the system.

E. Control of physical access to computers by the use of locked doors and guards should be used in addition to passwords in order to maintain security.

Argument Evaluation

Situation	Passwords are intended to control access to computers, limiting access only to intended users. Employees often choose easily guessed passwords. To improve security, therefore, employers should assign randomly generated passwords.
Reasoning	*What would significantly undermine the argument's conclusion?* Any evidence that suggests that assigning randomly generated passwords would be no more likely to be secure than employee-generated passwords would undermine the conclusion.

A. Even if in theory a randomly generated password could assign an employee a password the employee might have selected, that in actuality is extremely improbable.

B. **Correct.** If employees frequently record their randomly generated passwords where people who are not intended to have access to their computers can easily see them, as this option indicates, then such randomly generated passwords might in such cases reduce rather than increase security.

C. This detail is irrelevant because the issue is whether an unauthorized user can easily enter a valid password, not an invalid one.

D. This does not undermine the conclusion because the issue is whether the proposed plan does in fact increase the level of security maintained at the computer system.

E. This does not undermine the conclusion because this simply details a possible security measure that could be employed in addition to passwords.

The correct answer is B.

•

The economy around Lake Paqua depends on fishing of the lake's landlocked salmon population. In recent years, scarcity of food for salmon there has caused a decline in both the number and the size of the adult salmon in the lake. As a result, the region's revenues from salmon fishing have declined significantly. To remedy this situation, officials plan to introduce shrimp, which can serve as a food source for adult salmon, into Lake Paqua.

Which of the following, if true, most seriously calls into question the plan's chances for success?

A. Salmon is not a popular food among residents of the Lake Paqua region.

B. Tourists coming to fish for sport generate more income for residents of the Lake Paqua region than does commercial fishing.

C. The shrimp to be introduced into Lake Paqua are of a variety that is too small to be harvested for human consumption.

D. The primary food for both shrimp and juvenile salmon is plankton, which is not abundant in Lake Paqua.

DO NOT COPY filippo.fiz@uptoten.it

Printed by: filippo.fiz@uptoten.it. Printing is for personal, private use only. No part of this book may be reproduced or transmitted without publisher's prior permission. Violators will be prosecuted.

D. The primary food for both shrimp and juvenile salmon is plankton, which is not abundant in Lake Paqua.

E. Fishing regulations prohibit people from keeping any salmon they have caught in Lake Paqua that are smaller than a certain minimum size.

Evaluation of a Plan

Situation In recent years, scarcity of food for landlocked salmon in Lake Paqua has led to a decline in number and size of the salmon there, leading to a decline in revenues from salmon fishing, on which the area's economy depends. Officials plan to remedy this situation by introducing shrimp, a common food source for adult salmon, into Lake Paqua.

Reasoning *What would seriously undermine the plan's chances for success?* Note that shrimp are described as a food source for *adult* salmon. If there were good reason to think that shrimp cannot serve as a significant source of food for juvenile salmon—or that shrimp would not be able to live sustainably in the lake—there would be reason to be skeptical of the plan's eventual success.

A. Whether salmon is a popular food among residents around Lake Paqua is not particularly relevant to the question of whether introducing shrimp will help the salmon population there rebound.

B. Nothing in the plan depends on whether salmon fishing's primary contribution to the economy of the Lake Paqua region comes from tourists fishing or from commercial fishing.

C. The plan does not depend on the shrimp being usable as a human food source, only on their utility as food for salmon.

D. **Correct.** If the plan does not resolve the food source problem for juvenile shrimp, then the salmon may not survive to adulthood. Furthermore, because shrimp depend on plankton, which are not plentiful in the lake, any relief that the introduction of shrimp may provide will likely not be sustainable.

E. If anything, this would seem likely to assist the plan, by aiding in restoring the salmon population in the lake.

The correct answer is D.

Questions 673–738 — Difficulty: Medium

673. Airline representative: The percentage of flight delays caused by airline error decreased significantly this year. This indicates that airlines listened to complaints about preventable errors and addressed the problems. Although delays caused by weather and other uncontrollable factors will always be part of travel, preventable delays are clearly decreasing.

Which of the following most clearly points to a logical flaw in the representative's reasoning?

A. Airlines may be motivated by financial concerns to underreport the percentage of flight delays caused by airline error.

B. The delays caused by uncontrollable factors could have led to an increase in complaints to airlines.

C. Complaints may not be the most reliable measure of how many errors occurred in a given year.

D. Delays caused by weather and other uncontrollable factors could have increased dramatically during the year under discussion.

E. Airline customers might not believe that particular delays were caused by uncontrollable factors rather than airline error.

Argument Evaluation

Situation According to an airline representative, the percentage of flight delays caused by airline error decreased significantly this year. The representative concludes that airlines have addressed preventable errors reported by travelers.

Reasoning *Which of the answer choices most clearly suggests a logical flaw in the reasoning of the airline representative?* Flight delays can be caused in many ways: for example, by unpredictable bad weather, mechanical or computer failures, bad management, or some combination of these. Some but not all errors of these kinds—and the flight delays they might cause—are preventable. Note that the argument is focused on *the percentage* of all flight delays that are airline-error (AE)

DO NOT COPY filippo.fiz@uptoten.it

Printed by: filippo.fiz@uptoten.it. Printing is for personal, private use only. No part of this book may be reproduced or transmitted without publisher's prior permission. Violators will be prosecuted.

that the argument is focused on the percentage of all flight delays that are airline error (AE) delays. This percentage can decrease by (1) a reduction in the number of AE delays or (2) an increase in the number of non-AE delays, i.e., those delays that the airline could not have prevented. Even if a significant increase occurred in the number of AE delays, such delays could have decreased as a percentage of all flight delays if there had been a large enough increase in non-AE flight delays.

A. The hypothesis stated in this answer choice offers a slight, indirect basis for wondering whether the information on which the representative bases the reasoning is accurate. However, it provides no direct grounds for supposing that the reasoning itself is logically flawed. Even to the extent that this gives any reason to doubt the truth of the purported information, the relevance is very indirect. Even if airlines *may* have a motivation to underreport the percentage of flight delays caused by airline error, there is little reason to suppose that the representative's information may be a result of any airline's acting on such a motivation. And the representative argues on the basis of a decrease in the percentage, not on the basis of any particular percentage. If airlines systematically underreported the percentages, a decrease would still likely be significant.

B. This is only remotely relevant because the representative's quantitative comparison is about a difference in percentage of actual delays due to certain factors, not about a difference in numbers of complaints about such delays. In principle, if the total number of complaints increased and the increase was at least partially attributable to delays caused by uncontrollable factors, this information could suggest that the number of delays caused by uncontrollable factors might have increased. This, in turn, could indirectly suggest the hypothesis stated in answer choice D. But at best the relevance of answer choice B to such a hypothesis is very oblique and conjectural.

C. The issue being discussed primarily concerns flight delays. Airlines could make many kinds of errors that do not lead to flight delays and that generally do not elicit complaints from air travelers.

D. **Correct.** As explained above, if there is a large enough increase in non-AE flight delays—delays entirely due to factors outside an airline's control—then the overall number of flight delays also increases, provided the number of AE flight delays remains constant or also increases. So, even if the number of AE flight delays did not decrease, the percentage of all flight delays that were AE flight delays could decrease.

E. Air travelers who experience flight delays and disbelieve the explanations given by airlines for those delays may be justified in doing so—but in many, or even most, cases also may be mistaken. We have no information as to how this would affect the number of complaints from travelers. Certainly, the general level of trust between airlines and their customers does not affect the facts regarding the rate of AE flight delays or the rate of non-AE flight delays.

The correct answer is D.

674.

DO NOT COPY filippo.fiz@uptoten.it